thanks to the efforts of a handful of local enthusiasts, none more energetic than Dr B. Jambulingam, Superintendent of the Tamil University in Thanjavur. Since 1993 Dr Jambulingam has been tracking down long-neglected Buddhist statues or following up reports of new discoveries in the countryside around Thanjavur. In his doctoral thesis delivered in 2000 Jambulingam listed sixty granite Buddha images found in five of Tamil Nadu's thirty districts.[17] And Buddhist statues continue to come to light. In July 2012 a life-size stone statue of the Buddha was unearthed during construction work in the village of Kandramanikkam, in the same district as Sellur. Three months later the discovery of a slightly smaller decapitated statue was reported from the hamlet of Kiranthi, just south-west of Nagapattinam – making it the sixty-seventh stone statue to be recovered in this prime Chola country since Independence.



The Buddha in meditation under the Bodhi tree guarded by two Naga snake-kings, one of the many Chola 'bronzes' found under the streets of Nagapattinam, now in the Chennai Museum.